

## Road Safety: TIRRA Working Group Report March 2024

An informal group came together to discuss road safety on Thetis Island. We have since been accepted as a working group under TIRRA (Thetis Island Residents' and Ratepayers').

Note: the "downtown/central" area referenced for priority focus is from the intersection of Forbes Road and North Cove, to Pilkey Point (North-South) and from the Community Dock to Marina Road (East end) (West-East).

Our initial actions were to communicate with MOTI (Ministry of Transportation and Infrastructure) and ICBC to determine the level of support we could receive.

MOTI: We requested attention to the following:

- A. Line Painting throughout the island: would assist users in recognizing the narrowness of roadways and highlight the slower speeds required to navigate corners while staying in lane.
- B. Vegetation scraping in central area: to give better walking surfaces and assist in road sharing.
- C. Signage about narrowness of roadways: signs were created (thank you Veronica Shelford) for MOTI consideration.
- D. Reflector placement on encroaching trees, etc.
- E. Speed bumps at either end of Ferry corridor.
- F. Reduced speed limits.

MOTI Response:

- A. Line painting is contracted out by MOTI. No commitment to prioritize Thetis Island: we will continue to escalate/pursue as a critical component.
- B. Vegetation scraping is being tested (Lake Cowichan) and MOTI will advise the outcomes achieved, so consideration.
- C. Made on Thetis signage can not be posted on road right of ways only personal properties. We will take MOTI up on their offer to provide standard "share the road" signs, and will be making our version available to property owners.
- D. Joe Lange (Emcon) has been diligently out placing reflectors. If you need one in your neighbourhood let us know. Thank you, Joe!
- E. Speed bumps will not be considered.
- F. Speed limit reductions will not be considered.

ICBC: Discussion with the Safety Representative for our Area:

She hopes to attend our Community Day to talk with residents about road safety.

She is going to work with her colleagues to consider development of pamphlets for BC Ferry island routes. Something to be handed to visitors and viewed in poster format on the ferries.

She is sourcing funding to assist in purchase of two sharable lighted barriers to be used by any group planning an event which could increase vehicular or foot traffic in a specific location. (For Community Day, Saturday Market, etc.)

What our group is doing!

Creating awareness through espokes messaging.

Vegetation removal (tree limbs, shrubs) within the downtown area. We will be reaching out for volunteers to assist on our first work party in April. Our first intersection will be Forbes Road and North Cove. Before taking any action, we will be discussing with adjacent property owners.

Our work group discussed whether increased signage or decreased limits would improve road safety. We are instead going to focus on positive re-enforcement programs, and awareness events.

If you wish to join our team to brainstorm and implement ideas regarding road safety awareness, compliance: Please contact one of the following: Carolyn Askew, Carol Stoker, Andrea Gall, Wendy Hinsperger